

Unit 2 Social and Biological Psychological Debates

Content overview

Topic C: Do TV and video games affect young people's behaviour?

This topic covers the causes of aggression including biological and social learning causes.

Topic D: Why do we have phobias?

This topic considers social learning, conditioning and evolutionary causes of phobias.

Topic E: Are criminals born or made?

This topic considers proposed biological and social causes of criminality.

Assessment overview

- Assessed through an external examination.
- The paper consists of multiple choice questions, short answers and some extended writing and lasts 1 hour and 45 minutes.
- There are 90 marks in the examination and the result contributes 60% to the total grade for the full GCSE.

Methodological terms

Students will also be assessed on their understanding of the following terms from Unit 1, and their use when referring to methodology:

- i independent variable
- ii dependent variable
- iii experimental hypothesis
- iv experimental (participant) design: repeated measures and independent groups
- v control of variables
- vi qualitative data
- vii quantitative data
- viii generalisability
- ix reliability
- x subjectivity and objectivity
- xi ethical issues from Unit 1.

Detailed unit content

Topic C Do TV and video games affect young people's behaviour?

1. Explaining the question: Do TV and video games affect young people's behaviour?

Students will be assessed on their understanding of:

- a causes of aggression including:
 - i biological (limbic system and amygdala, hormones)
 - ii social learning including from TV and video games (Social Learning Theory: role models, vicarious reinforcement, modelling, observational learning, identification)
- b biological and social learning explanations of aggression by comparing them, including an evaluation of each
- c the nature-nurture debate in relation to understanding aggression
- d the evidence for individual differences in aggression drawing on Ramirez et al (2001) and Anderson and Dill (2000).

In the examination, students could be asked to demonstrate their understanding of stimulus material drawing on key terms and explanations.

2.

Investigating the question: content analysis

Students will be assessed on their understanding of:

- a the following terms, and their use when referring to methodology:
 - i sampling and generalisability issues in a content analysis
 - ii identifying categories and tallying
 - iii reliability of content analysis

In examination, students could be asked to design a content analysis from stimulus material, drawing on the terms above.

- b the ethical issue of protection of participants and how this may be dealt with
- c the aims, procedures and findings (results and/or conclusions) and evaluation of
 - i Anderson and Dill (2000) *Video games and aggressive thoughts, feelings and behaviour in the laboratory and in life*
 - ii Ramirez et al (2001) *Cultural and sex differences in aggression*
 - iii Charlton et al (2000) *Children's playground behaviour across five years of broadcast television: a naturalistic study in a remote community*
 - iv Williams (1981) *How and what do children learn from television.*

3. Why psychology matters

Students will be assessed on their understanding of:

- a the effects of television on aggression using the findings (results and/or conclusions) of Charlton et al's (2000) study and Williams' (1981) study; including comparing them
- b the role of an educational psychologist including:
 - i who they might work for
 - ii what they do
 - iii skills required
 - iv qualifications required
 - v chartered status
 - vi what they might do to help a child with anger management problems.

In the examination, students could be asked to demonstrate their understanding of stimulus material drawing on key terms and explanations.

4. Exploring the question further

Students will be assessed on their understanding of:

- a the role and effectiveness of censorship including;
 - i the role of the 9 pm watershed
 - ii arguments for and against censorship.

In the examination, students may be asked to demonstrate their understanding of stimulus material drawing on key terms and explanations.